

Kuri: A friendly home-assistant and security guard

For \$699, you can now own a robot that does more than just keep an eye on your house. **Kuri** is a 50cm tall robot that moves around your house like one of the family. With Wi-Fi and Bluetooth connectivity, it is always in touch with you. Its eyes, with built-in high-definition cameras, can be your eyes when you are away from the house. With facial recognition features, Kuri is actually



Kuri is a cute robot that helps, inspires and keeps an eye on your house (Courtesy: Mayfield Robotics)

capable of recognising people and even judging their moods. It alerts you when it spots unknown people or something amiss in the house. A 4-microphone array helps Kuri react to voice commands and noises. Its speakers can also entertain you with music, engage your kids with stories, or help you catch up on news or podcasts. Kuri is also able to learn general patterns of behaviour. So it can wake you up if you are late for work!

With easily programmable tasks and 'IF This Then That' (IFTTT) automation capabilities, Kuri connects with your smarhome systems. It has

a long battery life, and even when it is out of sap, it just goes for a nap near its charging pad and recharges automatically!

Above all else, Kuri can connect with the family emotionally. It reacts to pats on the head, speaks to you in a very cute robot language, keeps your kids company and even plays with your pets. So it is a security, helper and friend, all in one!

Company: Mayfield Robotics; **Country:** United States of America; **Website:** <https://www.heykuri.com/>

LyfieEye: Capture 360-degree content with your mobile phone

There is nothing new about 360-degree cameras, but one that is tiny and works with your Android smartphone is truly awesome! eCapture Technologies claims that its **LyfieEye** is the world's smallest 360-degree video camera for Android phones. This affordable device plugs directly into your phone and enables you to record, play and share life-like spherical 360-degree videos and photos. The content can be shared instantly on Facebook 360 or YouTube 360. The camera can also be synced to a virtual reality headset, so you can relive your special moments.

Inside the 18gm camera are two Super-FishEye lenses, each providing a 180-degree field-of-view. Image sensors help to capture whatever the lenses are pointing at. The camera records videos at 30 frames per second.

Thanks to its patented chip, Ly-



LyfieEye is a tiny 360-degree camera that plugs into your Android phone (Courtesy: eCapture Technologies)

fieEye can instantly flatten and stitch together images and videos captured by the two lenses and sensors. The recording is then transmitted in real time to your smartphone via the plug-in connector. Plug-in connection ensures that your 360-degree camera works reliably without depending on Wi-Fi or Bluetooth connections.

LyfieEye is available at an MRP of \$149.

Company: eCapture Technologies Inc.; **Country:** United States of America; **Website:** <https://www.lyfie.com/>

U by Moen: Wi-Fi connected shower controller

Your morning shower can make or break your day! Sometimes the water is extremely hot or cold if somebody else in the family has changed the mixer settings, or the hot water takes too long to reach the faucet. This makes you upset, especially if you are in a hurry to get ready for the office. For such situations, **U by Moen** smart shower is definitely a product worth investing in.

The kit includes a digital thermostatic valve, a Wi-Fi enabled digital controller and a mobile app, which lets you remotely set up your bath from anywhere in your home. The kit can be



Customise your bath with U by Moen smart shower

used to control up to four water outlets, depending on your existing shower setup. The valve setup is supposedly do-it-yourself, but early adopters say that it is a bit complicated and requires a plumber's services.

Once you set up the system, you can customise elements of your bath such as temperature, time and outlet selection using the controller or mobile app. You can configure up to twelve presets, so all your family members can get their bath the way they want it. When it is time for your bath, the system drains the cold water remaining in the pipes, heats the water to the required temperature, pauses the water flow, and waits for you to step in and enjoy your bath.

For people with real need or love for luxury, the smart shower is a worthy investment. It can also be useful in boutique hotels, which can save preferences of their regular clients to boost customer satisfaction.

Company: Moen; **Country:** United States of America; **Website:** <http://www.moen.com/u>